

# Final Term Project Specification

## AI-Assisted MBSE Transformation of the Mid-Term Project

Revised Edition · Prepared for Student Groups

**Core framing: Use AI to transform, audit, connect, and challenge your system model—not simply to rewrite your mid-term report.**

### 1. Project Purpose

Each group will transform its mid-term systems engineering project into an AI-assisted MBSE package. The final project should demonstrate a connected digital thread:

**Stakeholder Needs → ConOps → Operational Requirements → System Requirements  
→ Functions + Architecture → Interfaces → Verification → Traceability → Change Impact**

### 2. Rules and Expectations

- AI may support extraction, structuring, consistency checking, traceability, and simulation design. Students remain responsible for all engineering decisions.
- Do not allow AI to invent facts, standards, thresholds, stakeholder decisions, or performance targets. Mark uncertain items as [ASSUMED], [INFERRED], [NEEDS SOURCE], or [HUMAN DECISION REQUIRED].
- Reward is based on model clarity and traceability, not report length.
- Every major requirement, function, interface, verification case, and change impact should be traceable to a source or rationale.

### 3. Required Tasks in Order — 8 Tasks

Complete the tasks in sequence. Each task builds on the previous one. The MBSE views they cover are shown in the right column.

| # | Task Name                                                                     | What to Produce                                                                                                                                         | MBSE Views Covered | Replaces / Condensed From |
|---|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|---------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Freeze the Mid-Term Baseline</b><br><br>(Quick anchor — do not over-write) | Summarize original mission, boundary, stakeholders, needs, requirements, architecture.<br><br>Identify 3–5 weaknesses in the mid-term SE work that MBSE | Baseline           | Task 1                    |

| # | Task Name                                                                | What to Produce                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | MBSE Views Covered        | Replaces / Condensed From |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|
|   |                                                                          | should fix.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                           |                           |
| 2 | <b>Build the Operational View</b>                                        | <p>Write ConOps (mission, users, environment, concept of use).</p> <p>Write 2–3 use cases and one normal scenario + one abnormal scenario.</p> <p>State 3–5 operational success criteria (measurable).</p>                                                                                                          | Operational               | Task 2                    |
| 3 | <b>Build the Requirement View</b>                                        | <p>Convert stakeholder needs into Operational Requirements (OR) and System Requirements (SRS).</p> <p>Each requirement needs: unique ID, rationale, assumption flag, and verification method.</p> <p>Note: parent-child links (OR→SRS) will be captured in the Task 7 RTM—no separate trace column needed here.</p> | Requirements              | Task 3                    |
| 4 | <b>Build the Functional &amp; Architecture View</b><br><br>[Merged task] | <p>List the top 5–8 system functions (what the system does, not how).</p> <p>Define major system blocks (subsystems or components).</p> <p>Allocate each function to one or more blocks in a simple table.</p> <p>A standalone function hierarchy is not required—just the allocation.</p>                          | Functional + Architecture | Merges Tasks 4 + 5        |
| 5 | <b>Build the Interface View</b><br><br>[Scoped: 3–5 interfaces]          | <p>Select the 3–5 most critical external or internal interfaces.</p> <p>For each interface, provide: Interface ID, Sender, Receiver, Data/Material Exchanged, and Linked Requirement.</p> <p>Trigger and failure mode columns are optional (include only if relevant to your system's risk).</p>                    | Interface                 | Task 6                    |
| 6 | <b>Build the Verification View</b>                                       | Define one verification case per OR (test, analysis, inspection, or                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Verification              | Task 7 (lightweight)      |

| # | Task Name                                                                         | What to Produce                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | MBSE Views Covered       | Replaces / Condensed From                          |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
|   |                                                                                   | <p>demonstration).</p> <p>Each case needs: Case ID, linked SRS ID, method, pass/fail criterion, and who verifies.</p> <p>Depth over breadth: one well-written case is better than five vague ones.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                          |                                                    |
| 7 | <b>Build the Traceability View + Run the AI Audit</b><br><br><b>[Merged task]</b> | <p><b>Part A — Traceability RTM:</b><br/>Build an RTM showing at least one complete digital thread from stakeholder need → OR → SRS → function → block → interface → verification case. Full-matrix coverage is not required; demonstrate the chain for your top 2–3 requirements.</p> <p><b>Part B — AI Audit:</b><br/>Use an LLM to audit the RTM for: missing links, weak requirement language, hidden assumptions, contradictory requirements, and interface gaps. Document what AI found, what you accepted, what you rejected, and why.</p> | Traceability + AI Review | Tasks 8 + 9                                        |
| 8 | <b>Scope One Change Impact</b><br><br><b>[Focused, not full rescan]</b>           | <p>Select one meaningful change request (a new stakeholder need, a tighter performance target, or a new constraint).</p> <p>Trace its impact through exactly three layers:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>(a) Which requirements change or are added?</li> <li>(b) Which blocks or interfaces are affected?</li> <li>(c) Which verification cases must be updated?</li> </ul> <p>State the risk introduced by the change. Full re-analysis of all views is not required.</p>                                                          | Change Impact            | Task 10 (scoped to 3-layer trace, not full rescan) |

The final presentation (Task 9 in the original spec) remains a required deliverable — see Section 5.

## 4. Required Deliverables

| Deliverable                             | Notes                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Group MBSE Transformation Report</b> | One integrated report covering all 8 tasks. Does not need to be long—a well-connected model of modest depth is better than a large document with shallow connections. |
| <b>RTM / Traceability Matrix</b>        | Show at least one complete digital thread from need to verification. Partial RTM covering 2–3 top requirements is acceptable; full-matrix coverage is not required.   |
| <b>AI Usage Log</b>                     | Document prompts used, output accepted, output rejected, human corrections made, and AI risks discovered. Format is flexible—a table or annotated log both work.      |
| <b>Change Impact Analysis</b>           | One meaningful change, traced through three layers: requirements, architecture/interfaces, and verification. One to two pages is sufficient.                          |
| <b>Final Group Presentation</b>         | Explain the transformation from mid-term to MBSE, what AI helped discover, what AI got wrong, and the final digital thread.                                           |
| <b>Individual Final Thoughts</b>        | "Advice to Future SE Students Entering the AI Era." Strict 500-word limit. Personal, specific, and connected to your project experience.                              |

## 5. Final Group Presentation

The final presentation should cover four things, in any order that tells a clear story:

- The transformation: what changed from the mid-term report to the MBSE model, and why.
- What AI helped you discover: gaps, inconsistencies, or improvements you would not have found alone.
- What AI got wrong: hallucinated facts, wrong assumptions, weak requirements generated by AI, and how you corrected them.
- The digital thread: walk the audience through one complete chain from a stakeholder need to a verification case.

## 6. Optional Bonus: AI-Assisted System Simulation

Bonus may be awarded only when simulation supports a real systems engineering decision.

- Simulation must link to a requirement, MOE/MOP, or design trade-off.
- Inputs, assumptions, variables, and output metrics must be clearly stated.
- At least two scenarios or sensitivity cases should be compared.
- The result must lead to an engineering decision, requirement revision, or risk insight.

Acceptable tools: Excel, Python, SimPy, AnyLogic, n8n, MATLAB, or any appropriate tool with instructor approval.

## 7. Grading Structure

Total final term project grade: 100%. Part I is the group project. Part II is the individual final thoughts.

Note on Part I: The Part I criteria below preserve the requested emphasis of 10/40/20/20. Because

these add to 90 raw points, the Part I score is scaled to 80% of the final term project grade: Part I final contribution = raw Part I score ÷ 90 × 80.

## Part I — Group AI-Assisted MBSE Transformation: 80%

| Criteria                           | Raw Weight | What to Evaluate                                                                                     | Excellent Performance Looks Like                                                                  |
|------------------------------------|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Transformation Clarity</b>      | 10         | How clearly the group transforms the mid-term project into MBSE.                                     | Original weaknesses are identified; improvements are visible and traceable.                       |
| <b>MBSE Structure Completeness</b> | 40         | Operational, requirement, functional, architecture, interface, verification, and traceability views. | A complete digital thread connects needs to verification. Change impact is focused and traceable. |
| <b>AI Use Quality</b>              | 20         | Prompt log, human correction, AI risk awareness, assumption control.                                 | Students use AI as an engineering reviewer and correct false or weak outputs.                     |
| <b>Final Presentation</b>          | 20         | Clarity, professionalism, storytelling, and ability to explain the model.                            | The audience can understand the system, the model, and the learning within limited time.          |

## Part II — Individual Final Thoughts: 20%

Each student submits an individual reflection titled: "Advice to Future SE Students Entering the AI Era." Strict 500-word limit. Personal, specific, and connected to the project experience.

| Criteria                                 | Weight | What to Evaluate                                                                             |
|------------------------------------------|--------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Personal insight                         | 8%     | What the student personally learned about SE, MBSE, and AI.                                  |
| Connection to project experience         | 5%     | Specific examples from the group project, not generic AI discussion.                         |
| Understanding of AI limitations          | 5%     | Clear recognition of AI mistakes, assumptions, hallucination risk, and human responsibility. |
| Usefulness of advice and writing clarity | 2%     | Advice is practical, concise, and useful for future SE students.                             |

## 8. Suggested Reflection Questions for Part II

- What did you misunderstand about systems engineering before this course?
- What did MBSE help you see that your mid-term report did not show clearly?
- What did AI do well during the transformation?
- What did AI do poorly or dangerously?
- Which SE skill becomes more important because AI exists?
- What advice would you give to future SE students entering the AI era?

**In the AI era, systems engineers will not be valued because they can generate more documents.**

They will be valued because they can define the right system boundary, ask the right questions, connect models across the lifecycle, detect inconsistency, make trade-offs, and govern AI-assisted engineering work.